



DIRECTION TO ELDA WING

Physical Preparedness

COMDT ACS DIRECTION OF 10 SEPTEMBER 2026 APPLIED TO ELDA DELIVERY

New Zealand Army Leadership Centre | Army Command School

Reference: COMDT ACS discussion, 10 September 2026 · **Date:** September 2026 · **Status:** For action

Context

COMDT ACS has identified a need to strengthen physical preparedness across promotion training. His direction is that soldiers should arrive on promotion courses having already met the required Army physical standards, with assurance of those standards sitting with units and NCO School. ELDA is not to become an additional point of physical fitness assessment.

Direction

Accordingly, the following applies to ELDA delivery.

1. **ELDA remains a leadership development environment.** Physical pressure is used deliberately to create interference and develop leadership under pressure.
2. **Do not assess or grade physical fitness.** ELDA instructors are not to apply additional or informal fitness standards.
3. **Allow legitimate teamwork.** Load sharing and supporting team members are appropriate where they contribute to achieving the task.
4. **Preserve the developmental environment.** Instructors remain coaches and facilitators. Fitness assessment must not undermine openness, reflection or psychological safety.
5. **Report significant concerns.** Genuine concerns regarding a learner's physical preparedness are to be reported discreetly to SI ELDA, who will report directly to SI NCO School for follow-up.

Bottom Line

Continue to use physical pressure where it supports the learning outcome. Our role is to develop and observe leadership under pressure, not to assess physical fitness.